✋ Bleeding from a limb that cannot be controlled with direct pressure?

N → **USE** direct pressure with sterile gauze. Pack junctional wounds (torso, neck, groin).

Y → **APPLY** tourniquet immediately. Proceed below.

Child's limb large enough for CAT tourniquet? (approx. 13 cm circumference, typically age 2+)

N → **USE** SWAT-T or RATS tourniquet if available. Otherwise: direct pressure

1. improvised tourniquet.

Y → **USE** CAT Gen 7 tourniquet.

PLACE tourniquet 5–7 cm above wound (proximal, toward heart). Over single bone (upper arm or upper thigh), not over joint.

TIGHTEN until bleeding stops completely. CAT: turn windlass, secure clip. SWAT-T: stretch and overlap.

🕐 **RECORD** time of application on tourniquet or child's skin. Use 24-hour format (e.g., TQ 1430).

Has bleeding stopped after tourniquet?

N → **APPLY** second tourniquet proximal to first. Tighten both. Add direct pressure if bleeding continues.

Y → **MAINTAIN** tourniquet. 👁️ Monitor for shock. Continue to Page 2.

📱 **CALL** 101 if not already done. **TRANSPORT** urgently to hospital.

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Monitoring & Transport

👁️ **CHECK** tourniquet has not loosened.
CHECK bleeding has stopped.
MONITOR for shock: rapid weak pulse, pallor, cool mottled skin, altered consciousness.

↓

KEEP child warm to prevent hypothermia.
REASSURE child and parent.
Report time, device, and condition to arriving EMS.

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Reference Notes

DO NOT:

✕ **Do NOT remove a tourniquet once applied** — only hospital personnel should remove it.
✕ **Do NOT apply a tourniquet for venomous animal bites** (snakes, scorpions, spiders) — tourniquets worsen envenomation outcomes.
✕ **Do NOT apply a tourniquet over a joint** (elbow, knee) — place on upper arm or upper thigh.
✕ **Do NOT apply a tourniquet too loosely** — an insufficiently tight tourniquet causes venous bleeding without arterial occlusion, worsening blood loss.
✕ **Do NOT use a standard CAT tourniquet on very small infant limbs** (under 13 cm circumference) — it will not be effective.
✕ **Do NOT delay tourniquet application** to attempt prolonged direct pressure on massive haemorrhage.
✕ **Do NOT forget to record the time of application.**

Equipment needed:

— CAT (Combat Application Tourniquet) Gen 7 — for children aged ~2+ with sufficient limb size
— SWAT-T tourniquet — for all pediatric sizes including very small limbs
— RATS tourniquet — alternative for all pediatric sizes
— Improvised tourniquet materials (triangular bandage + rigid windlass object)
— Marker or pen (to record time of application)
— Sterile gauze (for wound packing if needed)
— Phone (to call 101)

Pediatric Tourniquet Sizing Guide

Age / Size	Device	Notes
Age 2+, limb 13 cm+	CAT Gen 7	Upper + lower extremity
Age 6+, limb 16 cm+	CAT Gen 7	Reliable both extremities
All pediatric sizes	SWAT-T / RATS	Effective on very small limbs
Infants < 2 years	Direct pressure	No evidence for manufactured TQ

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Hebrew Terminology — מונחים בעברית

English	עברית	Pronunciation
Tourniquet	חוסם עורקים	kho-SEM or-KIM
Bleeding	דימום	di-MUM
Tighten	הדק	ha-DEK
Windlass	מוט סיבוב	MOT si-BUV
Above the wound	מעל הפצע	me-AL ha-PE-tsa
Time of application	זמן הנחה	ZMAN ha-na-KHA
Shock	הלם	HE-lem
Ambulance	אמבולנס	am-bu-LANS
Emergency	חירום	khe-RUM
The child needs a tourniquet	הילד צריך חוסם עורקים	ha-YE-led tsa-RIKH kho-SEM or-KIM
The bleeding won't stop	הדימום לא נעצר	ha-di-MUM LO ne-e-TSAR

Source: Magen David Adom (MDA) — MDA Tourniquet Application Guidelines — Pediatric
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